A LISTENING GUIDE

WORLD PR FORUM · ABUJA · NOVEMBER 2026

Six Episodes on Trust



From Stories and Strategies, the world's most listened-to PR podcast.

Trust sits at the center of these six conversations. Together they look at who we believe, why confidence in institutions keeps fracturing, what AI is doing to judgment, where ethics must step in, and how even deception can complicate the meaning of trust. Each page includes a featured episode and listening links.

Six featured conversations plus two bonus episodes.

EPISODE 228 · MAY 5, 2026 · 23 MINUTES

AI vs Social Media. Which do We Trust More?

GUEST: Rochelle Ford, PhD, APR

CEO, The Page Society



Fifty percent of consumers in the Page-Harris Poll now say they trust generative AI for information about companies and brands. That puts AI ahead of social media overall. Rochelle Ford explains why that changes the work of communicators, from disinformation risk to the need to optimize for AI-driven discovery.

Listen for

How trust in generative AI overtook social media, what that means for brand reputation, and how communicators should respond.

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EPISODE 172 · APRIL 8, 2025

Who Do You Trust? Rethinking Media in a Fractured World

GUEST: Tina McCorkindale, PhD

President and CEO, Institute for Public Relations



Audiences are spreading their attention across traditional media, owned channels, podcasts and creators. Tina McCorkindale looks at what happens to credibility in that fractured environment, and what communicators can do when the old hierarchy of trusted sources no longer holds.

Listen for

Why news avoidance is rising, which sources people trust now, and why owning communication channels matters.

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EPISODE 218 · FEBRUARY 24, 2026 · 22 MINUTES

Public Relations in the Age of Insularity

GUEST: Tim Weber

Managing Director and EMEA Head of Editorial, Edelman



The 2026 Edelman Trust Barometer suggests trust is retreating into smaller circles. Tim Weber explains how public relations now operates in a world of hardened perspectives, 'turtle shells,' and widening divides, where the task is less simple persuasion and more trust brokerage.

Listen for

What insularity means, why trust keeps narrowing, and how organizations can counter fear and rebuild confidence.

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EPISODE 247 · SEPTEMBER 15, 2026 · 21 MINUTES

Cognitive Surrender and What It Means to Public Relations

GUEST: Dr Steven Shaw, PhD

King's College London and Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania



AI may do more than generate content. It may weaken the habit of independent thought. Steven Shaw studies 'cognitive surrender,' the tendency to accept AI-generated answers without proper scrutiny. For public relations, that has consequences for both practitioners and the audiences they seek to reach.

Listen for

Why people accepted wrong AI answers so often, and what happens when AI starts shaping judgment.

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EPISODE 20 · SEPTEMBER 13, 2020

The Ethics of AI in PR



EPISODE 20 | Anne Gregory and Jean Valin

Long before today's wave of AI anxiety, Anne Gregory and Jean Valin were asking what ethical safeguards communicators would need. This conversation looks at algorithmic bias, accountability, human oversight and the responsibility to protect the public when automated systems influence decisions and information.

Listen for

Why ethical guardrails matter, where bias enters AI systems, and how communicators can keep people at the centre.

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EPISODE 79 · JANUARY 8, 2023 · 23 MINUTES

When Lies Build Trust

GUEST: Emma Levine, PhD and Maurice Schweitzer, PhD

Behavioural researchers at Chicago Booth and the Wharton School



We are taught that lies destroy trust. Emma Levine and Maurice Schweitzer explain why some prosocial lies can actually increase it, at least in the short term. Their research opens a more nuanced conversation about benevolence, honesty and what people are really judging when they decide who to trust.

Listen for

The difference between prosocial and self-serving lies, and why kindness and honesty can pull in different directions.

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BONUS EPISODE · EPISODE 148 · OCTOBER 20, 2024

Regulating PR. What Three African Nations are Doing

GUEST: Arik Karani

President, African Public Relations Association



BONUS EPISODE 148 | Arik Karani

Three African nations have introduced mandatory certification for public relations professionals. Arik Karani explains the reasoning behind those rules, the safeguards they seek to establish, and how regulation could influence the credibility and accountability of the profession.

Listen for

Certification, ethical standards, enforcement and whether professional regulation can strengthen public confidence.

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BONUS EPISODE · EPISODE 248 · SEPTEMBER 22, 2026

World PR Forum Wants Your Say on Public Relations Rules

GUEST: Adrian Cropley

Centre for Strategic Communications Excellence



Who gets to write the rules of public relations? Adrian Cropley discusses the Global Alliance consultation behind the Abuja Declaration and asks what society has the right to expect from communications professionals, from ethics and regulation to international representation.

Listen for

Why the Abuja Declaration matters, whether PR practitioners should be licensed, and what happens after principles are adopted.

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